

Performance Review Policy

This policy covers employee performance review cycles, evaluation criteria, rating levels, performance discussions, and the process for requesting a review of a performance rating.

12.1 Review Cycle. All regular employees are normally evaluated through a formal performance review once every 12 months. The annual review cycle is intended to assess performance against established responsibilities, objectives, and behavioral expectations.

12.2 Mid-Year Review. Managers should conduct a mid-year performance discussion approximately 6 months after the employee's annual review. The discussion may be used to review progress, identify development needs, and adjust objectives when business priorities have changed.

12.3 New Employees. Employees who have not completed their probationary period may be evaluated through the probation process rather than the standard annual performance review cycle. After confirmation, the employee is included in the applicable performance review cycle.

12.4 Performance Criteria. Performance reviews may consider quality of work, achievement of objectives, productivity, communication, teamwork, attendance, problem-solving, professional conduct, and other responsibilities relevant to the employee's position.

12.5 Rating Scale. Employee performance is assessed using a five-level rating scale: **1 — Does Not Meet Expectations, 2 — Partially Meets Expectations, 3 — Meets Expectations, 4 — Exceeds Expectations, and 5 — Exceptional Performance.**

12.6 Rating Definitions. A rating of 3 indicates that the employee consistently meets the normal expectations of the position. Ratings of 4 or 5 indicate performance above the standard expectations, while ratings of 1 or 2 indicate that one or more significant performance expectations have not been consistently achieved.

12.7 Manager Assessment. The employee's manager is responsible for preparing the performance assessment using available performance information and the requirements of the employee's position. Managers should provide specific examples supporting significant positive or negative assessments.

12.8 Employee Discussion. Employees should have an opportunity to discuss their performance review with their manager before the review is finalized. Employees may provide comments or additional information that they believe is relevant to the assessment.

12.9 Final Rating. The final performance rating should be documented through the designated HR process. Completion of the review discussion does not automatically require the manager to change the proposed rating.

12.10 Performance Improvement. Employees receiving a rating below the expected performance level may be required to participate in a performance improvement process. The process may establish specific objectives, review dates, training requirements, and expected improvements.

12.11 Rating Appeal. An employee who believes that a final performance rating contains a material factual error or was determined without appropriate consideration of relevant performance information may submit an appeal to Human Resources within **10 business days** of receiving the finalized review.

12.12 Appeal Documentation. A performance-rating appeal should identify the specific rating being challenged, explain the basis for the appeal, and provide relevant supporting information. General disagreement with a manager's judgment without supporting information may not require a change to the rating.

12.13 Appeal Review. Human Resources may review the employee's appeal, the manager's assessment, supporting documentation, and other relevant information. When appropriate, HR may request additional information from the employee or manager.

12.14 Appeal Outcome. The appeal review may confirm the original rating, require correction of a documented factual error, or request that the review be reconsidered through the designated process. The employee should normally receive the appeal outcome within **15 business days** after the required information has been received.

12.15 Confidentiality. Performance reviews and associated records should be handled as confidential personnel information and shared only with individuals who have a legitimate business reason to access them.

12.16 Policy Compliance. Managers and employees are responsible for participating in performance reviews according to the applicable schedule and procedures. Exceptions to the standard review cycle require appropriate management or Human Resources approval.